Double Sided Combs - Inscriptions

33 pieces

Inv. no. 2588

Wood

W: 8.1 cm; H: 7.5 cm

Gifted by the Egyptian Museum of Antiquities

Wooden comb with an inscription set within cartouches on both sides which reads: “Among what was made for the exalted presence, al-Najashi Najm al-Din Ayyub ibn al-Basha”.

Inv. no. 3883

Wood

W: 7.1 cm; H: 6.4 cm

Donated by Dikran Kelkian, 20th century

Wooden comb with an inscription on both sides which reads: “My passion called me to disobedience, but modesty and generosity forbade me”. Ascribed to the work of “Nasir ibn al-Baba”.

Inv. no. 4920

From the ruins of al-Fustat

Wood

W: 7.8 cm; H: 8.3 cm

Wooden comb inscribed on both sides with the phrase “Lasting Glory” in the center, and “Good Fortune” repeated twice on either side. The prominent calligraphy and large irregular octagons are both complemented by the consistent use of ring-and-dot motifs.

Inv. no. 4922

From the ruins of al-Fustat

Wood

W: 8.2 cm; H: 7.2 cm

Wooden comb with an inscription on both sides which reads: “Among what was made for the noble and exalted presence, al-khatuni, may his life endure”, interrupted by large medallions inset with six-petalled flowers.

Inv. no. 4923

From the ruins of al-Fustat

Wood

W: 4.9 cm; H: 8.3 cm

Fragment of a wooden comb inscribed with the words: “The exalted” in a central cartouche on both sides, flanked by decorative medallions and ring-and-dots.

Inv. no. 4927

From the ruins of al-Fustat

Wood

W: 9.2 cm; H: 8.1 cm

Wooden comb with inscriptions on both sides with the phrase “Lasting Glory”, interrupted by a central medallion with a five-petalled whirling rosette, and flanked on either side by large ring-and-dot motifs and openwork medallions.

Inv. no. 4929

From the ruins of al-Fustat

Wood

W: 8 cm; H: 7.4 cm

Wooden comb with naskh inscriptions on both sides which read: “O Lord, grant me a good ending.”

Inv. no. 4930

From the ruins of al-Fustat

Mamluk, 648-923 AH / 1250-1517 CE

Wood

W: 5 cm; H: 6.2 cm

Fragment of a wooden comb with inscriptions on both sides which read: “Lasting Glory”, with the rank of the napkin (buqja), signifying the position of the master of robes (jamdar) during the Mamluk period.

Inv. no. 4933

From the ruins of al-Fustat

Wood

W: 5.7 cm; H: 9.2 cm

Fragment of a wooden comb, similar to No. 4930, with an inscription along the surviving edge which reads: “Good Fortune”, flanked on either face by two decorative medallions and with a large openwork cartouche in the center.

Inv. no. 4934

From the ruins of al-Fustat

Wood

W: 5 cm; H: 8.3 cm

Fragment of a wooden comb with an inscription in naskh along the surviving edge, surrounded by openwork designs and rings-and-dots.

Inv. no. 4935

From the ruins of al-Fustat

Wood

W: 6.3 cm; H: 8.6 cm

Fragment of a wooden comb with an inscription in naskh rounding the corner which reads: “Indeed, I am in a palm”, and geometric openwork decoration in the central band.

Inv. no. 4936

From the ruins of al-Fustat

Wood

W: 6.1 cm; H: 9.5 cm

Fragment of a wooden comb with an inscription in naskh rounding the corner which reads: "I am a comb made for grooming," and geometric openwork decoration in two horizontal bands, flanked by a smaller vertical band.

Inv. no. 4937

From the ruins of al-Fustat

W: 2.1 cm; H: 8.6 cm

Fragment of a comb with a central inscription band flanked at the top and bottom by two openwork bands with geometric motifs.

Inv. no. 6621/2

Wood

W: 5.3 cm; H: 7.9 cm

Registered January 3, 1924

Purchased from Muhammad Sa'd Ahmad

Fragment of a wooden comb with a prominent inscription in naskh which reads: "Making the head beautiful is the least of my virtues, I am a crown upon the forehead," with interspersed ring-and-dot motifs.

Inv. no. 8323

Wood

W: 9.4 cm; H: 8.3 cm

Registered February 20, 1929

Purchased from Monsieur Tellal

Wooden comb with an ornate inscription in naskh, carved in relief, which reads: “I am a comb, made for grooming; I have groomed only the finest”. A central medallion on one face bears the phrase: “Who seeks”, with the phrase: “Finds” on the other. Rounding the corners at both ends of the comb are the phrases: “Lasting Glory” and “Success.”

Inv. no. 9273

Boxwood

W: 7.6 cm; H: 8 cm

Registered May 6, 1930

Boxwood comb with partially-preserved teeth on both sides, and an inscription in naskh which rounds each corner and reads: “Among what was made for the Amir Sayf al-Din”.

Inv. no. 9274

Boxwood

W: 7.5 cm; H: 7.5 cm

Registered May 6, 1930

Boxwood comb with partially-preserved teeth on both sides and a carved naskh inscription in relief set within cartouches which reads: “By order of the noble Amir Sayf al-Din Ibn Sa‘id”, flanked by two prominent finials.

Inv. no. 14766

From the collection of Abdallah Michael

Boxwood

W: 9.9 cm; L: 8 cm

Registered May 12, 1942

Boxwood comb, partially preserved, with two cartouches on either end with carved inscriptions in naskh, and large decorative medallions with carving and openwork, flanked by smaller rings-and-dots in the central band.

Inv. no. 18764/1

Wood

W: 6.1 cm; H: 8 cm

Registered May 6, 1957

Submitted by Dr. Muhammad Mustafa

Wooden comb, partially-preserved, with inscriptions in naskh on both sides which read: “Lasting Glory”, set within a rounded cartouche, and flanked by openwork medallions and ring-and-dot motifs.

Inv. no. 18764/2

Wood

W: 6 cm; H: 8.2 cm

Registered May 6, 1957

Submitted by Dr. Muhammad Mustafa

Wooden comb, partially-preserved, with inscriptions in naskh on both sides which read: “Lasting Glory”, set within a rounded cartouche, and flanked by openwork medallions and ring-and-dot motifs

Inv. no. 18764/3

Wood

W: 6.7 cm; H: 7.2 cm

Registered May 6, 1957

Submitted by Dr. Muhammad Mustafa

Wooden comb with an inscription on both sides which reads: “When hardship closes in upon you, then reflect upon Alam Nashrah,” directing the reader to Surat al-Inshirah (Q. 94), with its repeated assurance that ease accompanies hardship.

Inv. no. 18764/8

Wood

W: 5.1 m; H: 11.7 cm

Registered May 6, 1957

Submitted by Dr. Muhammad Mustafa

Section of a wooden comb, partially-preserved, with inscriptions or pseudo-inscriptions on both sides in a prominent angular style.

Inv. no. 19400/3

Wood

W: 9.8 cm; H: 11.1 cm

Registered December 14, 1957

Purchased from the poet Muhammad ʻAbd al-Rahim

Wooden comb, partially preserved, with a Kufic inscription on one side and vegetal decoration on the other.

Inv. no. 20660/1

Wood

W: 8.7 cm; H: 8.5 cm

Registered January 1, 1959

Wooden comb, partially preserved, with inscriptions on both sides set within round cartouches, flanked by decorative medallions and rings-and-dots; one face bears the word al-ʿarraf (“the diviner”), the other lafit (“the striking one”).

Inv. no. 20660/2

Wood

W: 7.5 cm; H: 9.3 cm

Registered January 1, 1959

Wooden comb, partially preserved, with an incomplete inscription on both sides in two registers, with interspersed ring-and-dot motifs.

Inv. no. 21520/1

Wood

W: 4.2 cm; H: 8.2 cm

Registered November 18, 1959

Half of a wooden comb, with part of a cursive inscription located in a central cartouche and another along the surviving edge, set within a decorative medallion.

Inv. no. 21520/2

Wood

W: 4.1 cm; H: 9.5 cm

Registered November 18, 1959

Wooden comb, partially preserved, with inscriptions in medallions and ring-and-dot motifs along the central band and edges.

Inv. no. 21520/3

Wood

W: 3.9 cm; H: 7.7 cm

Registered November 18, 1959

Wooden comb with an inscription in a central cartouche, flanked by decorative medallions and rings-and-dots.

Inv. no. 21520/4

Wood

W: 6 cm; H: 6.5 cm

Registered November 18, 1959

Wooden comb, partially preserved, with an inscription in the central band interrupted by a medallion bearing a napkin (buqja), representing the rank of the master of robes (jamdar) during the Mamluk period, all flanked by rings-and-dots.

Inv. no. 21520/5

Wood

W: 6 cm; H: 5.2 cm

Registered November 18, 1959

Wooden comb, partially preserved, with inscriptions on either face and along the surviving edge, set within decorative medallions.

Inv. no. 21520/6

Wood

W: 4.1 cm; H: 7.8 cm

Registered November 18, 1959

Wooden comb, partially preserved, with inscriptions set within decorative medallions along both faces and the surviving edge.

Inv. no. 21618/2

Wood

W: 5.3 cm; H: 8.5 cm

Wooden comb, partially preserved, with a central cartouche inscribed with an inscription in naskh with the partially legible word rafi‘ (“fine” or “exalted”). on one face, and decorative rings-and-dots.

Inv. no. 23497

From excavations in al-Fustat

Wood

W: 9.5 cm; H: 7.7 cm

Registered February 24, 1966

Wooden hair comb, double-sided, with one row of coarse teeth and another of fine teeth. A central band separates the two rows, bearing inscriptions on both faces. One side reads: “The most noble lord”, while the other names “Nasir al-Din Muhammad”. Circular medallions appear at the end of the band, forming the common dedicatory phrase, “Eternal Glory”, bordered by an arrangement of rings-and-dots.

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